

China banks

June credit data - demand weakness and loan pricing pressure persists

The June credit data shows a consistent narrative of resilient production and weak consumption, as highlighted by our macro team ([link](#)). Both TSF and new loans missed expectations, with continued deceleration in credit growth. Our take is negative on a net basis. First, new loans continue to disappoint, with retail lending contracting 1.3% y/y in June. Second, pricing for new corporate loans contracted sequentially and on a y/y basis; this, along with mix deterioration in 2Q, will add pressure to the banks' overall loan yield, offsetting the benefit from time deposits re-pricing. Third, weak demand suggests pressure on the overall economy; asset quality of retail loans will likely remain under pressure. In addition, remarks at the PBOC press conference suggest that addressing weak loan growth is a low policy priority, as policymakers shift their focus from quantity-based to price-based policy management. Thus, we prefer high-quality banks with earnings resilience. We like CCB, BOC and ICBC among SOE banks, and Citic and CMB among JSBs.

What we don't like about the credit data

- **New TSF and loans missed expectations:** Growth rate of TSF balance continued to decelerate, to 7.4% y/y in Jun-26 from 7.7% in May, within that, RMB loan growth moderated to 5.2% y/y from 5.5% y/y in May. New TSF and RMB loans were Rmb3.36tn and Rmb1.61tn, respectively, rebounding m/m on seasonality but both missing Bloomberg expectations of Rmb3.71tn and Rmb1.95tn. Please refer to Table 1 for details.
- **Weakness in retail loans persists:** New retail loans were only Rmb265bn in Jun-26, down from Rmb598bn in Jun-25, and accounted for just 16% of total new loans. Retail loan growth declined further to -1.3% y/y from -0.9% in May, with medium- to long-term retail loan growth moderating to 0.5% y/y from 0.8% and short-term retail loan growth falling to -6.7% y/y from -6.0%. This points to continued weakness in both mortgage-related and consumer-credit demand. The silver lining was that discounted bills accounted for only 7% of new loans in June, down sharply from 107% in May, while April new-loan creation was almost entirely supported by bill financing. Corporate loans excluding bills also rebounded to Rmb1.38tn in June from Rmb80bn in May. The PBOC mentioned that growth rate of SME loans was 8.3% y/y, M/L industrial loans was 5.9% y/y and M/L service sector loans (excluding real estate) was 5.9% y/y, all above the overall loan growth rate of 5.2% y/y. On a net basis, given the contraction in higher-yielding retail loan balance, we view the overall loan mix as having deteriorated.
- **New-loan pricing trended down:** Aside from mix, pricing for new corporate loans has declined. The PBOC commented that the weighted-average rate on newly issued corporate loans was ~3.0% in 6M26, around -20bps y/y and below the ~3.1% rate on new corporate loans in March 2026. For mortgages, the rate on newly issued personal housing loans was ~3.1% in 6M26, broadly stable y/y. The PBOC also indicated that the new-loan rate for inclusive small and micro-enterprise loans was ~3.57% in Jun, down 16bps y/y. On net, despite lack of a further rate cut, we believe 2Q26 new loans pricing may have trended down q/q, offsetting the positive impact from ongoing time deposits repricing. Thus, we

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expect 2Q26 NIM to be flattish to slightly down q/q, compared to the sequentially improving trend in 1Q26 (+3bps q/q by our covered banks).

- **M1 and M2 growth highlighted macro pressure:** M1 growth slowed to 4.0% y/y in Jun-26 from 5.5% in May, below Bloomberg consensus of 4.9%, while M2 growth moderated to 8.0% from 8.6%, also below BBG consensus. As a result, the negative M1-M2 growth gap widened to -4.0% from -3.1%, pointing to weaker macro conditions. This is consistent with the deceleration in real GDP growth to 4.3% y/y in 2Q26 from 5.0% in 1Q26. Please see our macro team's [note](#) for details.

What we like about the credit data

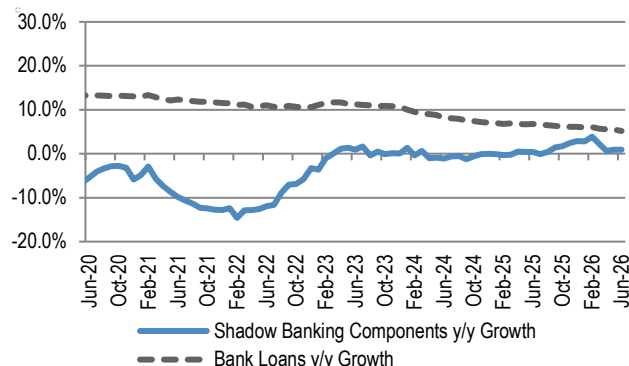
- **Corporate bond issuance remained robust and supported aggregate financing:** Corporate bond financing reached Rmb401bn in Jun-26, up 66% y/y and 139% m/m. Although government bond financing moderated to Rmb768bn in June, down 43% y/y, the outstanding balance of combined corporate and government bond financing still grew 12.8% y/y, materially above bank loan growth of 5.2%. The strength in bond financing provided support to overall TSF but may also have disintermediated bank lending and added to the slowdown in loan growth. This is consistent with the PBOC's view that loans alone no longer fully capture financing conditions and that loans and bonds should increasingly be assessed together.
- **Deposit growth (8.2% y/y) remained above loan growth (5.2% y/y), easing pressure on deposits competition:** Deposit growth was 8.2% y/y in Jun-26, moderating from 8.7% in May but remaining well above loan growth of 5.2%. This continued divergence points to ample system liquidity and should ease competition for deposits. Demand-deposit ratio was broadly stable m/m at 26.5% in May, with the corporate demand-deposit ratio increasing by 35bps m/m and the retail ratio declining by 18bps. Retail deposit growth was 7.1% y/y in June, still higher than corporate deposit growth of 4.5%, but decelerated from 7.5% in May and was less than half its previous peak of 18.3% in Feb 2023. This supports our view that incremental retail deposits are rotating into financial products. NBFIs deposits contracted by Rmb990bn m/m in June, but this was largely due to seasonality, compared with a Rmb520bn contraction in Jun-25.

Table 1: Jun-26 TSF data compared to JPMe and BBGe

Rmb bn	Actual Jun-26	BBGe Jun-26	JPMe Jun-26
TSF	3,360	3,710	4,063
New RMB loans	1,610	1,950	1,912
TSF growth(stock)	7.4%	7.5%	7.6%
Rmb loans growth (stock)	5.2%	5.4%	5.4%
M1 growth rate	4.0%	4.9%	NA
M2 growth rate	8.0%	8.5%	8.7%

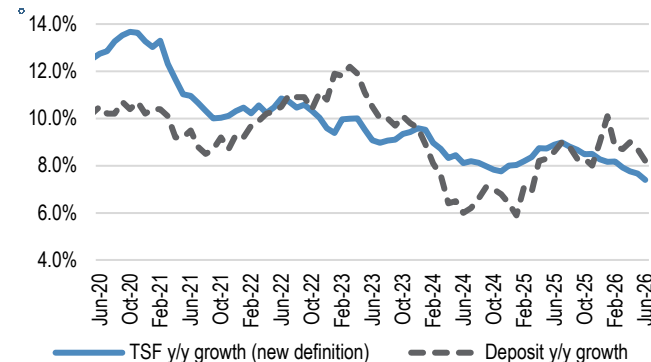
Source: PBOC, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan.

Figure 1: Total bank loan y/y growth in TSF was 5.2% y/y in Jun-26, declining from 5.5% y/y in May-26, and shadow credit growth was 1.0% y/y in Jun-26, vs. 1.0% y/y in May-26



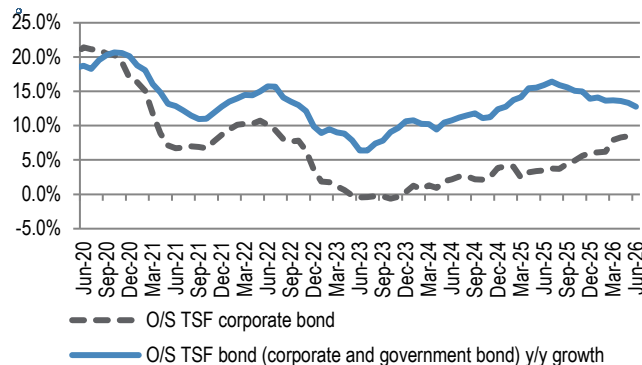
Source: PBOC, CEIC. Note: Shadow banking components in TSF include trust loans, entrusted loans and bankers' acceptance bills.

Figure 2: Official TSF growth edged down to 7.4% y/y in Jun-26, from 7.7% y/y in May-26 and deposit growth moderated to 8.2% y/y in Jun-26, vs 8.7% y/y in May-26



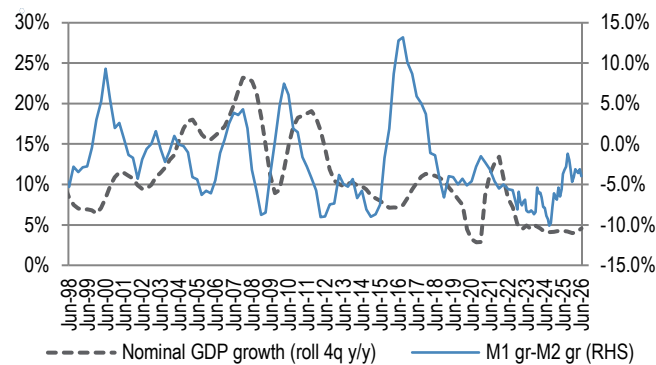
Source: PBOC, CEIC. Note: TSF (new definition) includes ABS issued by depository financial institutions, loans written off and government bonds.

Figure 3: Corporate and government bond financing growth edged down to 12.8% y/y in Jun-26 vs 13.3% y/y in May-26



Source: PBOC, CEIC.

Figure 4: The M1-M2 growth gap was -4.0% in Jun-26, widened from -3.1% in May-26



Source: PBOC, NBS, CEIC. Note: PBOC changed the definition of M1 since Jan-25, which now includes residential demand deposits and prepaid funds received by non-bank payment institutions.

Figure 5: Demand deposits ratio stayed flat m/m at 26.5% in May, with corporate demand deposits ratio +35bps m/m and retail -18bps m/m

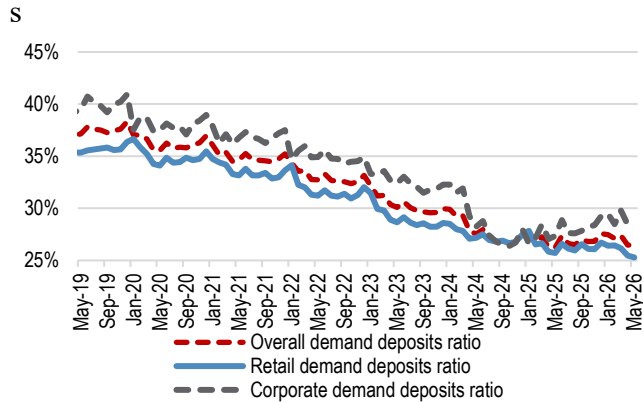


Figure 6: Corporate demand deposits growth edged up to 10% y/y in May-26, while household demand deposits increased by 6% y/y

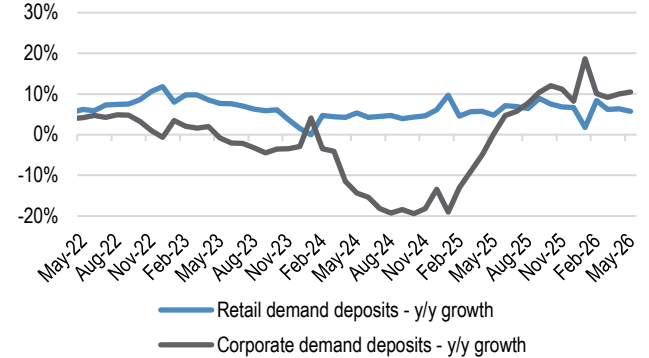


Figure 7: Corporate loan growth edged down to 8.2% y/y in Jun-26 from 8.4% y/y in May-26, and retail loan growth further dropped to -1.3% y/y in Jun-26 vs -0.9% y/y in May-26

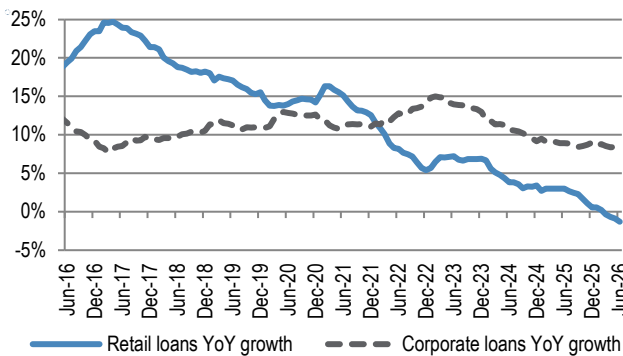


Figure 8: 3M-SHIBOR edged up by 3bps m/m, and 7D repo rose by 7bps m/m in Jun-26

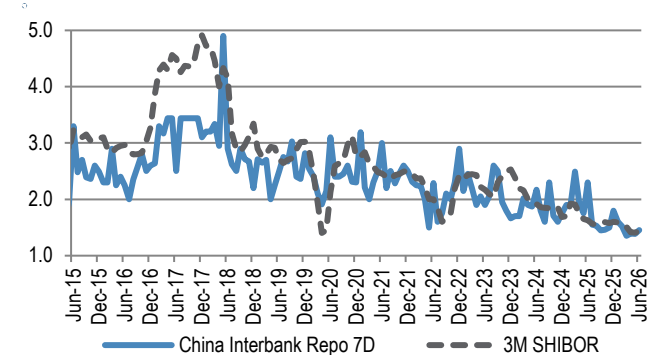


Figure 9: M/L retail loan growth weakened to 0.5% y/y in Jun-26 vs. 0.8% y/y in May-26, and short-term retail loan growth dropped further to -6.7% y/y in Jun-26 from -6.0% y/y in May-26

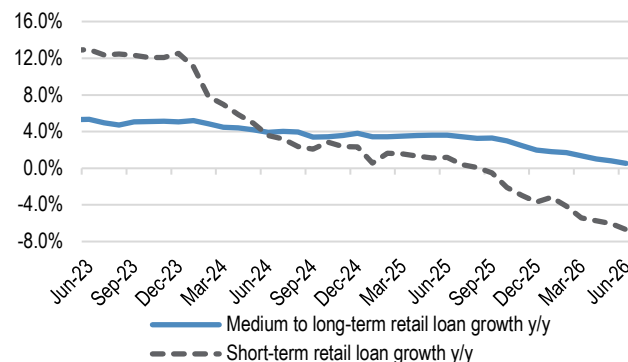


Figure 10: Corporate deposit growth edged up to 4.5% y/y in Jun-26 vs. 4.4% y/y in May-26, while retail deposit growth moderated to 7.1% y/y in Jun-26 vs. 7.5% y/y in May-26

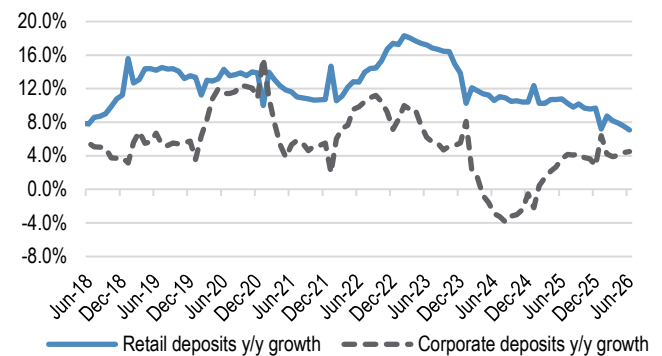
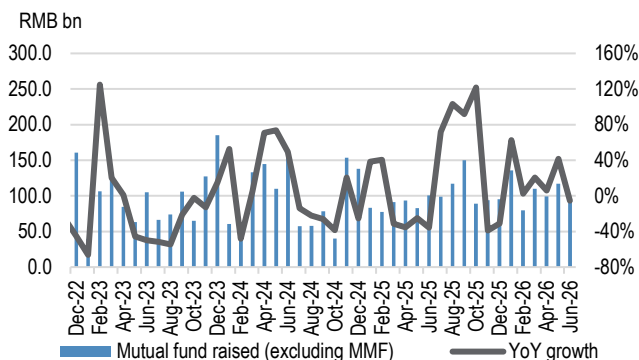
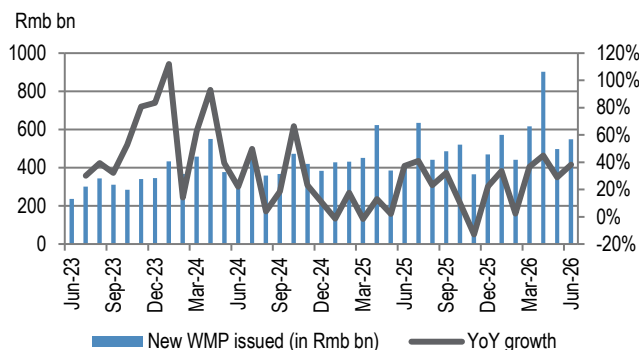


Figure 11: Total new mutual funds raised was Rmb95.3bn in Jun-26, -5% y/y



Source: WIND. Data as of 7 Jul 2026.

Figure 12: New WMP issued in Jun-26 was Rmb549bn, surging by 38% y/y, vs +29% y/y in May-26



Source: WIND. Data as of 13 Jul 2026.

Table 2: China new TSF breakdown

Rmb bn	2Q25	2Q26	YoY	Jun-25	May-26	Jun-26	MoM	YoY
Total amount of social financing	7,675	6,018	-22%	4,225	2,029	3,365	66%	-20%
Loans in RMB	3,041	1,861	-39%	2,360	497	1,765	255%	-25%
Loans in foreign currency	33	76	130%	33	12	46	289%	40%
Entrusted loans	-57	-13	-77%	-40	-9	24	-370%	-161%
Trust loans	91	-58	-163%	82	5	-50	-1049%	-162%
Bank acceptance bills	-586	-705	20%	-190	-69	-108	58%	-43%
Corporate bond financing	626	1,021	63%	242	168	401	139%	66%
Non-fin enterprise equity	75	176	136%	20	30	63	111%	209%
Government bonds	3,782	2,896	-23%	1,351	1,224	768	-37%	-43%
Others	670	764	14%	368	172	456	165%	24%
Composition								
Loans in RMB	40%	31%	-9ppt	56%	24%	52%	28ppt	-3ppt
Loans in foreign currency	0%	1%	1ppt	1%	1%	1%	0.8ppt	1ppt
Entrusted loans	-1%	0%	1ppt	-1%	0%	1%	1.2ppt	2ppt
Trust loans	1%	-1%	-2ppt	2%	0%	-1%	-2ppt	-3ppt
Bank acceptance bills	-8%	-12%	-4ppt	-4%	-3%	-3%	0.2ppt	1ppt
Corporate bond financing	8%	17%	9ppt	6%	8%	12%	4ppt	6ppt
Non-fin enterprise equity	1%	3%	2ppt	0%	1%	2%	0ppt	1ppt
Government bonds	49%	48%	-1ppt	32%	60%	23%	-37ppt	-9ppt
Others	9%	13%	4ppt	9%	8%	14%	5ppt	5ppt

Source: PBOC, CEIC, J.P. Morgan.

Table 3: Breakdown of new Rmb loans by counterparty

Rmb bn	New RMB loan balance					New RMB loan mix				
	Household	Corporate (excl. bills)	Bills	Others	Total loans	Household	Corporate (excl. bills)	Bills	Others	Total loans
Jan-25	444	5,200	(515)	1	5,130	9%	101%	(10%)	0%	100%
Feb-25	(389)	870	169	360	1,010	(39%)	86%	17%	36%	100%
Mar-25	985	3,020	(199)	(167)	3,640	27%	83%	(5%)	(5%)	100%
Apr-25	(522)	(230)	834	198	280	(186%)	(82%)	298%	71%	100%
May-25	54	440	75	51	620	9%	71%	12%	8%	100%
Jun-25	598	2,170	(411)	(117)	2,240	27%	97%	(18%)	(5%)	100%
Jul-25	(489)	(810)	871	378	(50)	979%	1620%	(1742%)	(756%)	100%
Aug-25	30	540	53	(33)	590	5%	92%	9%	(6%)	100%
Sep-25	389	1,620	(403)	(316)	1,290	30%	126%	(31%)	(25%)	100%
Oct-25	(360)	(160)	501	240	220	(164%)	(73%)	228%	109%	100%
Nov-25	(206)	270	334	(8)	390	(53%)	69%	86%	(2%)	100%
Dec-25	(92)	700	350	(48)	910	(10%)	77%	38%	(5%)	100%
Jan-26	457	5,230	(874)	(103)	4,710	10%	111%	(19%)	(2%)	100%
Feb-26	(651)	1,490	(35)	96	900	(72%)	166%	(4%)	11%	100%
Mar-26	491	2,830	(191)	(140)	2,990	16%	95%	(6%)	(5%)	100%
Apr-26	(787)	(870)	1,243	404	(10)	7869%	8700%	(12429%)	(4040%)	100%
May-26	(141)	80	557	24	520	(27%)	15%	107%	5%	100%
Jun-26	265	1,380	114	(149)	1,610	16%	86%	7%	(9%)	100%

Source: PBOC, J.P. Morgan.

Table 4: Breakdown of new Rmb loans by duration

Rmb bn	New Rmb household loans		New Rmb corporate loans (excl. bills)		New Rmb discounted bills	New loans non-bank FI	New Rmb loans (other)	Total new Rmb loans
	Short term	Long term	Short term	Long term				
Jan-25	(50)	494	1,740	3,460	(515)	(201)	202	5,130
Feb-25	(274)	(115)	330	540	169	284	75	1,010
Mar-25	484	505	1,440	1,580	(199)	(170)	0	3,640
Apr-25	(402)	(123)	(480)	250	834	163	38	280
May-25	(21)	75	110	330	75	59	(7)	620
Jun-25	262	335	1,160	1,010	(411)	(103)	(14)	2,240
Jul-25	(383)	(110)	(550)	(260)	871	203	179	(50)
Aug-25	11	20	70	470	53	(113)	79	590
Sep-25	142	250	710	910	(403)	(235)	(85)	1,290
Oct-25	(287)	(70)	(190)	30	501	94	142	220
Nov-25	(216)	10	100	170	334	-15	6	390
Dec-25	(102)	10	370	330	350	(77)	29	910
Jan-26	110	347	2,050	3,180	(874)	(188)	86	4,710
Feb-26	(469)	(182)	600	890	(35)	(11)	106	900
Mar-26	196	295	1,480	1,350	(191)	(169)	30	2,990
Apr-26	(446)	(341)	(460)	(410)	1,243	175	230	(10)
May-26	(84)	(57)	100	(20)	557	(86)	110	520
Jun-26	106	158	820	560	114	(143)	(6)	1,610

Source: PBOC, J.P. Morgan.

Table 5: Breakdown of new Rmb deposits by counterparty

Rmb bn	New Rmb deposit balance						New Rmb deposit mix					
	Household savings	Corporate	Fiscal	Non-bank FI	Others	Total deposits	Household savings	Corporate	Fiscal	Non-bank FI	Others	Total deposits
Jan-25	5,520	(206)	332	(1,110)	(216)	4,320	128%	(5%)	8%	(26%)	(5%)	100%
Feb-25	610	(894)	1,258	2,830	616	4,420	14%	(20%)	28%	64%	14%	100%
Mar-25	3,090	2,840	(771)	(1,411)	502	4,250	73%	67%	(18%)	(33%)	12%	100%
Apr-25	(1,390)	(1,330)	371	1,571	338	(440)	(316%)	(302%)	84%	357%	77%	100%
May-25	470	(418)	880	1,190	58	2,180	22%	(19%)	40%	55%	3%	100%
Jun-25	2,470	1,777	(820)	(520)	303	3,210	77%	55%	(26%)	(16%)	9%	100%
Jul-25	(1,110)	(1,459)	770	2,140	159	500	(222%)	(292%)	154%	428%	32%	100%
Aug-25	110	300	190	1,180	280	2,060	5%	15%	9%	57%	14%	100%
Sep-25	2,960	919	(840)	(1,060)	231	2,210	134%	42%	(38%)	(48%)	10%	100%
Oct-25	(1,340)	(1,085)	720	1,850	465	610	(220%)	(178%)	118%	303%	76%	100%
Nov-25	670	645	(50)	80	65	1,410	48%	46%	(4%)	6%	5%	100%
Dec-25	2,580	1,220	(1,382)	(330)	(408)	1,680	154%	73%	(82%)	(20%)	(24%)	100%
Jan-26	2,130	2,610	1,550	1,450	350	8,090	26%	32%	19%	18%	4%	100%
Feb-26	3,110	(2,655)	(350)	1,390	(326)	1,170	266%	(227%)	(30%)	119%	(28%)	100%
Mar-26	2,440	2,725	(739)	(810)	855	4,470	55%	61%	(17%)	(18%)	19%	100%
Apr-26	(1,940)	(1,250)	739	2,470	251	270	(719%)	(463%)	274%	915%	93%	100%
May-26	(110)	(170)	710	1,140	200	1,770	(6%)	(10%)	40%	64%	11%	100%
Jun-26	1,950	1,940	(939)	(990)	29	1,990	98%	97%	(47%)	(50%)	1%	100%

Source: PBOC, J.P. Morgan.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 15 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

Bank of China - H(3988.HK/HK\$4.65[13 February 2026]/OW), China Citic Bank - H(0998.HK/HK\$7.01/OW), China Construction Bank - H(0939.HK/HK\$8.17/OW), China Merchants Bank - H(3968.HK/HK\$46.20/OW), Industrial and Commercial Bank of China - H(1398.HK/HK\$6.41[13 February 2026]/OW)

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China Construction Bank - H (0939.HK, 939 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 04, 2006. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
26-Jul-23	OW	4.43	6.3
17-Aug-23	OW	4.12	5.4
04-Oct-23	OW	4.24	5.9
12-Oct-23	OW	4.44	5.95
20-Dec-23	OW	4.49	6.05
05-Mar-24	OW	4.85	6.45
08-Apr-24	OW	4.81	6
19-Apr-24	OW	4.86	6.1
30-May-24	OW	5.69	6.55
02-Aug-24	OW	5.46	6.7
10-Sep-24	OW	5.34	6.75
08-Jan-25	OW	6.02	6.9
13-Mar-25	OW	6.65	7.55
18-Apr-25	OW	6.67	7.9
19-Aug-25	OW	7.71	9.2
24-Oct-25	OW	7.88	9.5
22-Apr-26	OW	8.96	9.8
08-Jul-26	OW	7.83	10.1

China Merchants Bank - H (3968.HK, 3968 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 13, 2007. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
26-Jul-23	OW	36.00	56
30-Aug-23	OW	31.50	51
13-Oct-23	OW	33.40	53
10-Dec-23	OW	25.40	32
22-Feb-24	OW	31.45	37
12-Apr-24	OW	31.90	39
15-May-24	OW	37.10	44
01-Aug-24	OW	32.50	46
08-Sep-24	OW	30.30	42
08-Oct-24	OW	47.25	58
08-Jan-25	OW	38.45	53
12-Mar-25	OW	47.40	56
19-Aug-25	OW	48.56	61
03-Oct-25	OW	46.48	60
19-Jan-26	OW	47.52	61
22-Apr-26	OW	51.35	62

Industrial and Commercial Bank of China - H (1398.HK, 1398 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
26-Jul-23	OW	3.69	5.5
17-Aug-23	OW	3.42	4.7
13-Oct-23	OW	3.92	4.6
05-Mar-24	OW	4.02	5
30-May-24	OW	4.55	5.2
02-Aug-24	OW	4.35	5.5
01-Sep-24	N	4.49	5.1
08-Jan-25	OW	4.91	5.8
13-Mar-25	OW	5.53	6.3
18-Apr-25	OW	5.35	6.6
19-Aug-25	OW	5.88	7.2
24-Oct-25	OW	6.06	7.3
19-Jan-26	OW	6.35	7.35
22-Apr-26	OW	7.26	7.9
11-Jul-26	OW	6.66	8.4

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 18, 2006. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Bank of China - H (3988.HK, 3988 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
26-Jul-23	N	2.82	3
28-Jul-23	N	2.83	3.1
17-Aug-23	N	2.66	2.95
12-Oct-23	N	2.74	2.9
01-Nov-23	OW	2.74	3.2
17-Jan-24	OW	2.91	3.4
07-Mar-24	OW	3.10	3.8
30-May-24	OW	3.78	4
01-Aug-24	OW	3.48	4.2
10-Sep-24	OW	3.34	4
13-Nov-24	N	3.64	3.7
08-Jan-25	N	3.92	3.8
13-Mar-25	N	4.51	4.15
31-Mar-25	OW	4.59	5.4
19-Aug-25	OW	4.39	5.5
15-Sep-25	OW	4.46	5.7
23-Oct-25	OW	4.36	5.5
22-Apr-26	OW	5.25	5.8
09-Jul-26	OW	5.09	6.15

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jul 05, 2006. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

China Citic Bank - H (0998.HK, 998 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
26-Jul-23	N	3.73	4.2
06-Sep-23	N	3.58	3.8
13-Oct-23	N	3.70	3.6
08-Dec-23	N	3.50	3.8
07-Mar-24	N	4.18	4.5
12-Apr-24	N	4.20	4.4
01-Aug-24	N	4.68	4.55
16-Oct-24	N	5.03	4.8
08-Jan-25	OW	5.25	6.25
18-Apr-25	OW	6.07	6.8
19-Aug-25	OW	7.27	8.1
23-Oct-25	OW	7.43	8.85
19-Jan-26	OW	7.10	9.05
22-Apr-26	OW	8.37	9.3
10-Jul-26	OW	6.80	8.75

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Nov 23, 2009. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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